

love was liberating. At that moment, Charles' insecurity, which was driving his overspending, disappeared. Charles found that after his insecurity went away, so too in time did his financial problems.

Freedom: What are the Odds?

People for whom freedom is a motivating drive see money as a source of adventure and liberation. They use money to try and achieve their dreams. When controlled, the freedom motivation can be wonderful and help people live life to its fullest. When this motivation gets out of control, it can lead to the risky world of gambling.

Gambling can take many forms: playing the lottery, going to Las Vegas, day trading on the Internet, or choosing a job that pays mostly on commission. The commonality among all of these different versions of gambling is that they involve high risk for a potential huge reward. The price to pay for the chance of winning big is that the odds are greatly stacked against you. Why then, do so many people gamble?

For many, the allure of high-risk wagering is the vision of how their life would change if they did win big. The money from that commission would pay for an expensive car. The yearly payout from winning the lottery would negate the need to ever work again. A life of leisure would be the ultimate reward. If these things are not even remote possibilities in your current situation, you might take the chance. If you feel powerless on your own to change your life significantly, you may decide that the risk is worth it.

Another factor is patience. While your current plans might allow you to one day achieve your dreams, you may not want to wait. As you will learn in Chapter 11, saving money early and consistently is the best guarantee of reaching your goals. Unfortunately, the years of dedication that saving

